Faresight Blueprint: Flights + Hotels

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The plan in one page

Faresight is a free travel-deal service that only shows prices that are bookable now and genuinely below normal: flights first, then hotels, then flight + hotel trips. It earns from booking commissions, not subscriptions. It launches in India and grows market by market.

Who it's for	Price-sensitive travellers from India who book their own international trips, then the same people anywhere
The promise	Every deal shows its real normal price, every working date, and when it was last checked. No paywall, no inflated "was" prices
Why we win	Zomunk and Viamigos inflate their "usual" prices; most deal sites never re-check. Our audit found only 26 of 90 rival deals both bookable and 15%+ below normal
How it earns	Commission on flight and hotel bookings, plus insurance, eSIM and similar add-ons. Hotels pay far more per booking than flights, so they become the main income
Order of work	1. Flights in India (built, testing). 2. App and alerts. 3. Hotels for the same destinations. 4. Flight + hotel trip deals. 5. More countries
Next decision	Run the engine on real fares for 2 weeks and confirm at least 3 real flight deals a day before spending on growth

Where we are today

Research, the flight engine and the website design are done; the engine has not yet run on real fares, and nothing is live.

Area	Status	What exists
Market and competitor research	Done	Zomunk and competitor audit: ~5,000 test searches, 5 rival sites, 90 deals checked
Build spec (flights)	Done	Flight Deal Engine build spec
Flight engine	Built, tested on simulated fares	300 India routes, scanning, normal price, deep check, 6-hour re-checks, admin, website, booking redirect; 7 automated tests pass. On your PC in `Downloads\flight-deal-engine`
First real-fare run	Not started	`test-real.bat` (50 searches)
Website design	Done	Design canvas: home, deal, route, alerts, mobile home, mobile deal, all linked
App (installable web app)	In progress	Install prompt, push alerts, saved deals, offline viewing
Hotels	Not started	This blueprint
Brand name, domain, company	Not decided	"Faresight" is a working name
Affiliate accounts	Not applied	Skyscanner, Agoda, Booking.com, Travelpayouts

Launch plan: 7 days

Target: soft launch on Wednesday 4 November 2026 to 50–100 people, then open to everyone once the first week's numbers look right. Flights only. Hotels stay in the future plan.

Already done (29 Oct): the engine is tested on real fares. 48 of 50 live Google Flights searches returned a price, airline and stops, in about 1 minute for 480 credits. The Scrape.do key is active, with about 48 million credits this month.

What we launch with

#	Service	What the customer gets
1	Verified flight deals	Every deal is at least 25% below the route's normal price and re-checked every 6 hours. Error fares get a "possible mistake fare" label
2	City alerts	One message on Telegram or the WhatsApp channel when a real deal leaves their city
3	Every working date	A price calendar with every date pair at the deal price, not one example
4	Explore from your airport	Deals from your saved airports, filtered by budget or region
5	Honest deal endings	An ended deal stays visible with the reason it ended and a link to the next best one

Weeks 2–4 after launch: route guides (they need about 2 weeks of price history first), the "Is this a good price?" checker, route watch alerts, email alerts, the long-weekend planner, then the Android app.

Day by day

Day	What happens	Owner
Thu 29 Oct	Run `setup.bat` and `start.bat` so the 300-route scan starts building normal prices. Choose the name; check the .com/.in domain and Instagram/Telegram handles are free	You
Fri 30 Oct	Buy the domain and add it to Cloudflare (free plan). Create the Telegram channel, WhatsApp channel and Instagram account. Build the finished design into the real website	You + brother · Claude (website)
Sat 31 Oct	Rent a small server (about ₹1,500–2,500 a month) and move the engine there, so it runs 24/7 without your PC. Review the first deals together and tune the rules	You · Claude (move + tuning)

Day	What happens	Owner
Sun 1 Nov	Site live on the domain behind Cloudflare, but not announced. Add privacy policy, terms and contact pages. Apply to Travelpayouts (Skyscanner) with the live site	You · Claude (pages)
Mon 2 Nov	Turn on automatic Telegram posts. 10 friends test it on their phones; collect everything that breaks	Brother · Claude (fixes)
Tue 3 Nov	Pick and check the 10–15 launch deals. Make share images and the first 3 Instagram posts or reels	You + brother
Wed 4 Nov	Go/no-go check (below). If it passes, soft launch to 50–100 people	Both
Thu 5 Nov	Watch the numbers: clicks, sign-ups, and how many deals were still bookable when people clicked. Fix, then set the public launch date	Both · Claude

Go/no-go checklist for 4 November

- [ ] At least 10 live deals, each checked by a person and still bookable at the price shown
- [ ] Every "Book" button opens the right route, dates and roughly the price we show
- [ ] Pages load in under 3 seconds on a mid-range phone on 4G
- [ ] Telegram and WhatsApp posts arrive within minutes of a deal going live
- [ ] Privacy policy, terms and contact pages are live, and "delete my data" works
- [ ] Cloudflare is on, the admin page has a strong password, and `/api/deals` is behind a login
- [ ] A fresh Scrape.do key is in use, with a monthly credit cap set

Two things outside our control. Affiliate approval can take 1–3 weeks. Until then, booking links go straight to Skyscanner and earn nothing, which is fine for a soft launch. The first full scan takes about 2 days, so the later the engine starts, the thinner the deal list will be on launch day. Starting it today matters most.

Product

One rule runs through every product: show the real normal price, show what works, re-check it, and say when it ends. Hotels and trips reuse the flight engine's method, so each new product is a new data source, not a new system.

Product	What the customer gets	Why it matters	Starts
Flight deals	Return fares 25%+ below the route's normal price, every working date, booking link per date	The traffic driver and the trust builder	Phase 1
Alerts	WhatsApp, Telegram, app push or email for chosen airports and saving level; "watch this deal"	Turns visitors into repeat users without accounts	Phase 1–2
App	Installable web app: home-screen icon, push alerts, saved deals, offline view	Matches Zomunk, HolidayPirates and Going, which all have apps; no app-store wait	Phase 2
Route and price pages	"Delhi to Bangkok flights": normal price by month, cheapest months, past deals	Free Google traffic for every route, all year	Phase 2
Hotel deals	Hotels 25%+ below their own normal nightly price for the same dates, filtered by area and star rating	Hotels pay much more commission per booking than flights	Phase 3
Hotels on flight deals	On every flight deal: the best-value hotels for those exact dates	Lifts income from flight traffic we already have	Phase 3
Trip deals (flight + hotel)	"Bangkok, 7 nights, flight + 4-star hotel: ₹X, normally ₹Y"	Clear, shareable value; no rival shows a measured bundle price	Phase 4
Add-ons	Travel insurance, eSIM, airport transfers, activities	Extra commission per trip	Phase 3
More countries	UK, UAE, Southeast Asia, then US departures, each in its own currency	The method is the same everywhere	Phase 5

Not planned: paid tiers, our own booking or payment handling, customer accounts beyond saved deals and alerts. Selling travel directly would bring payments, refunds and licensing; linking to partners keeps us light.

Hotels

Hotels use the same method as flights: a hotel deal is a stay priced at least 25% below that hotel's own normal nightly rate for nearby dates. We start with the 40 destinations the flight engine already covers, so every flight deal can show hotels and every hotel deal links back to flights.

What counts as a hotel deal

1. **Unit:** one hotel, one check-in date, 2 or 4 nights, 2 adults.
2. **Normal price:** the median nightly rate for that same hotel, check-ins within 21 days either side, seen in the last 30 days. Never the hotel's or booking site's "was" price, which is often inflated.
3. **Deal test:** at most 75% of that normal rate, guest rating 8.0 or higher, and cheap on at least 3 check-in dates.
4. **Shown with:** star rating, area, free cancellation yes/no, total for the stay, and "checked X hours ago".
5. **Re-checked** every 12 hours (hotel prices move more slowly than flights) and expired with the reason.

Scanning at low cost. One hotel search for a city and dates returns about 20 hotels with prices, so we price cities, not single hotels. 40 cities × a check-in every 7 days for 6 months × 2 stay lengths is about 2,100 searches a week, roughly 9,000 a month: about an eighth of the flight engine's volume.

Data sources

Source	Use	Notes
Google Hotels results via a scraping API	Sweep and normal prices	Offered by SerpApi (`engine=google_hotels`, `rate_per_night`, `total_rate`), Oxylabs, ScrapingBee and Bright Data. Check whether Scrape.do offers it; the same terms-of-service risk as flights applies
Partner APIs (Agoda, Booking.com)	Live prices and availability for verification and booking links	Both offer partner APIs or widgets once approved (Agoda, Booking.com); lower legal risk than scraping

Booking partners and commission (published ranges; confirm with each programme on approval)

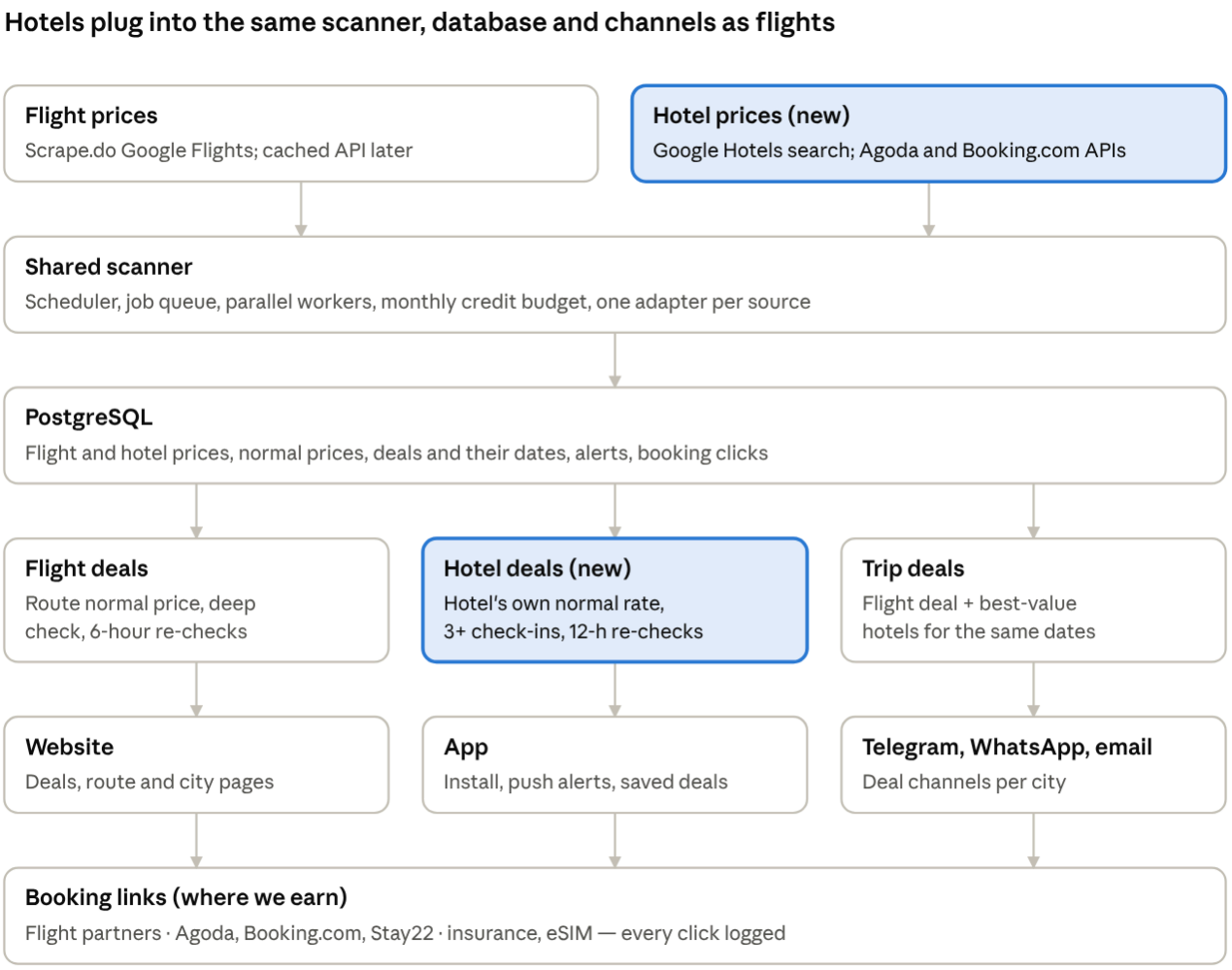
Partner	Commission	Payout	Why use it
Agoda	About 4–7% of booking value, rising with volume	Monthly, after the stay; cancellations reversed	Strongest in Asia, where most of our destinations are
Booking.com	25–40% of Booking.com's own commission; about 4–6% of the stay on a typical 15% commission	Monthly, after the stay	Largest inventory, strongest in Europe
Hotels.com	About 4–8%, 7-day cookie	Not stated	Third option for price comparison
Stay22	4–25% dynamic, 30–45-day cookie, no traffic minimum	Weekly options	Auto-matches the best-paying partner; fastest way to start before direct approvals

Sources for the commission table: track360 on Agoda, track360 on Booking.com, Stay22's 2026 programme list. These are secondary sources; the programmes' own terms decide.

What it's worth. A 4-night stay at ₹5,000 a night is ₹20,000; at 5% that pays about ₹1,000. A flight booking usually pays much less per booking, which is why hotels become the main income once traffic exists.

Architecture

Hotels need two new parts, a hotel price source and a hotel deal engine; the scanner, database, website, app, channels and booking links are shared with flights.



system architecture with hotels · hotel parts highlighted

The trip-deal step needs no new data: it combines a live flight deal with the best-value hotel prices already stored for the same dates. New tables: `hotels`, `hotel_observations`, `hotel_deals`, `hotel_deal_dates`, and a `kind` on `clicks` (flight, hotel, add-on).

Revenue model

All income comes from partners when a visitor books; users never pay. Flights bring the visitors, and hotels and add-ons earn most of the money.

Income line	How we're paid	Rate	Starts	Notes
Flight bookings	Affiliate link per date pair (Skyscanner, Travelpayouts and others)	Small per booking; confirm on approval	Phase 1	Volume and trust matter more than margin

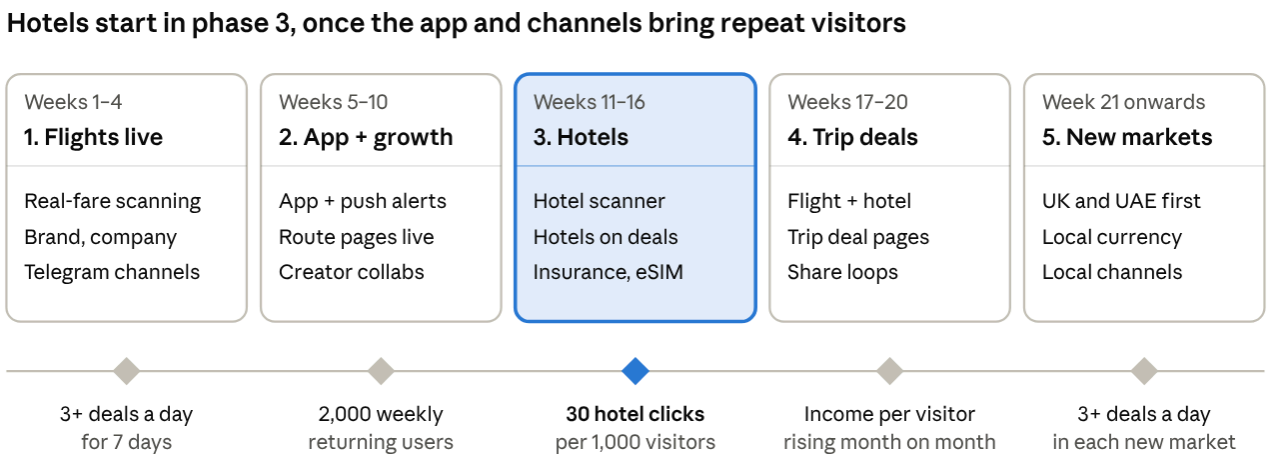
Income line	How we're paid	Rate	Starts	Notes
Hotel bookings	Agoda, Booking.com, Hotels.com, Stay22	About 4–7% of the stay (see Hotels)	Phase 3	Main income line
Hotels shown on flight deals	Same partners	Same	Phase 3	Earns from flight traffic we already have
Trip deals (flight + hotel)	Both links	Both	Phase 4	Highest value per visitor
Insurance, eSIM, transfers, activities	Affiliate	Varies; confirm on approval	Phase 3	Small per sale, near-zero extra work
Sponsored destination features	Tourism boards or airlines pay for a clearly labelled feature	Negotiated	Phase 5	Only labelled; never changes which deals qualify

Illustration, not a forecast. With 100,000 visitors a month, if 3% click a hotel link and 4% of those book a ₹20,000 stay at 5% commission, hotels earn about ₹1.2 lakh a month (100,000 × 3% × 4% = 120 bookings × ₹1,000). Every figure here is an assumption to replace with real numbers from Phase 2 onwards.

Rules that protect trust: a partner never pays to make a deal qualify; every page says we may earn a commission and that it doesn't change the price; booking always goes to the partner at the partner's price.

Roadmap

Five phases over about 5 months; each ends with a check that must pass before the next phase gets money or time.



roadmap · 5 phases, each ending in a gate

Weeks count from the first real-fare run. If a gate fails, fix that phase before moving on: hotels earn nothing without repeat visitors, and new markets are wasted if the first one has too few deals.

Growth

Zomunk grew from two influencer collaborations (about 1 million and 2.1 million views) while its own reels average about 11,000. Our plan copies what worked there and adds what it can't do: proof.

1. **Telegram and WhatsApp channels per city first.** Free, instant, and every deal is shareable. Target: 1,000 members in Delhi and Mumbai before paid promotion.
2. **Proof posts.** Short reels and posts that show a deal next to its real normal price and price chart, plus "we checked a competitor's 68% off: the real saving was about 7%". Cheap to make, and they build trust.
3. **2–3 creator collaborations** with travel creators, each with a tracked link or code, after the engine has run for a month and the site has real deals to show.
4. **Route pages for Google.** 300 route pages and 40 destination pages from the data we already collect; Google needs weeks to rank them, so they go live in Phase 2.
5. **Share loops.** "Send to a friend" on every deal and WhatsApp-ready previews; travel is usually booked with someone else.
6. **The app** as the retention tool: push alerts bring people back without paying for each visit.

Team, budget and costs

Two founders can run Phases 1–3 without hiring: one on engine and data, one on growth and partners. Fare data is the main cost; check provider prices against the volumes below before choosing plans.

Role	Covers	When
Founder: engine and data	Running the engine, data sources, website and app, deal quality	Now
Founder: growth and partners	Channels, creators, affiliate applications, brand, legal setup	Now
Part-time designer	Brand, photos, social templates	Phase 2
Part-time developer	Hotels module, second market	Phase 3, if the gates pass

Monthly running cost	Volume	Notes
Flight data	About 72,000 searches (~715,000 Scrape.do credits)	From the build spec; about 17,500 searches if the daily sweep moves to a cached API
Hotel data	About 9,000 searches	City searches, from Phase 3
Hosting	1 small server + managed PostgreSQL	Minor next to data
Messaging	Telegram free; WhatsApp business messaging is paid per conversation	Start on Telegram and WhatsApp channels
Creator collaborations	2–3 in Phase 2	Agree on tracked links or codes

One-off: domain and brand, company registration, legal review of data sources and terms (before Phase 3).

Metrics

Each phase has one number that decides whether we move on; the rest explain why it moved.

Phase	Deciding number	Target	Also watch
1. Flights live	Real flight deals per day (India)	3+ a day for 7 days	Share still bookable at re-check (aim 90%), median saving, credits per deal
2. App and growth	Weekly returning users	2,000	Channel members, app installs, push opt-in rate, booking clicks per deal
3. Hotels	Hotel booking clicks per 1,000 visitors	30	Hotel deals per city per week, partner conversion, income per 1,000 visitors
4. Trip deals	Income per 1,000 visitors	Set from Phase 3 data	Trip deals per week, share rate
5. New markets	Real deals per day in the new market	3+ a day	Cost per market, local channel growth

Risks and decisions

The largest risk is relying on scraped Google data for both flights and hotels; partner APIs are the way out and are applied for now.

Decisions needed now

- [ ] Brand name and domain (replace "Faresight")
- [ ] Company registration, needed for most affiliate programmes
- [ ] Who owns engine/data and who owns growth/partners
- [ ] Which hotel data provider to test (Scrape.do if it supports hotels, otherwise SerpApi, Oxylabs or similar)

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	What we do
Google's terms forbid scraping; a provider or Google could block access	Medium	High	Source adapters; apply to Agoda, Booking.com and flight partner APIs now; legal advice before scaling (this isn't legal advice)
Too few real deals to keep channels active	Medium	High	Measured in Phase 1; widen routes, add hotels sooner, or lower the bar to 20%

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	What we do
Data costs outrun income	Medium	Medium	Monthly budget cap in the engine; cached API for sweeps; hotel city searches are cheap
Affiliate approval is slow or refused	Medium	Medium	Stay22 states no traffic minimum; apply to several programmes at once
Hotel prices differ between our page and the partner (taxes, room type)	High	Medium	Show the total for the stay including taxes where available; 12-hour re-checks; "booking site shows the final price"
A rival copies the honest-pricing idea	Medium	Medium	Move fast on route pages, channels and the app; publish the method openly so trust stays with us

Website and app: what to build and how

One codebase, three ways in. The website is the product. It ships as an installable web app (a PWA) from day one, then gets wrapped for the app stores. We build one thing, not three.

Channel	How	When	Notes
Website + installable web app	Server-rendered pages, manifest, service worker, web push	Launch	Android and desktop push works straight from the browser
Google Play	Wrap the web app as a Trusted Web Activity with Bubblewrap, linked by Digital Asset Links	Month 2	About a week of work. A new *personal* Play account must first run a closed test (12 testers, 14 days). An *organisation* account skips that, so register the company first
Apple App Store	Capacitor wrapper with real native features: native push, home-screen widget, saved routes	Month 4–6	Apple rejects apps that are just a website in a frame (guideline 4.2), so this needs genuine app features

The iPhone push catch. Web push works on iOS 16.4 and later, but only after the person adds our site to their Home Screen and opens it from there. The permission prompt must come from a tap on a button, never on page load. So on iPhone our first alert channel is **email, Telegram or WhatsApp**, and we show a short "Add to Home Screen" guide *after* someone has signed up for their first alert, not before.

Speed targets (Google's Core Web Vitals, measured at the 75th percentile of real visits).

- Largest content shown (LCP): 2.5 seconds or less
- Response to a tap (INP): 200 ms or less
- Layout shift (CLS): 0.1 or less

We test on a mid-range Android phone on 4G, because that is our typical Indian visitor. In practice this means server-rendered deal pages, very little JavaScript, compressed images and no heavy chat widgets.

Search traffic (the free growth engine).

- One evergreen page per route, such as "Delhi to Bangkok flights". It shows the typical price, cheapest months, a price-history chart and live deals. This is how Skyscanner and Going earn Google traffic, and Zomunk has nothing like it.
- An expired deal page stays live with "This deal ended, get the next one" and an alert signup. It never shows a 404, because those pages collect links and shares.
- Every deal gets an auto-generated share image (price, route, dates), so WhatsApp and Instagram previews look like a poster.
- Structured data on route and deal pages. Separate country sites with language tags (hreflang) once we go beyond India.

Features, in build order.

1. Route alerts with "tell me when Delhi to Bali is under ₹18,000"
2. A "why this is a deal" box: normal price, today's price, how many dates work
3. Home airport and "anywhere from my city" explore
4. One-tap WhatsApp share
5. A price calendar on route pages
6. Hotels for the same dates (phase 3, see Hotels)
7. Hindi, then other languages

Privacy law (India's DPDP Act). The DPDP Rules were notified in November 2025, and most obligations phase in over about 18 months, roughly by mid-2027. Penalties under the Act go up to ₹250 crore. We build this in from the start, because it is cheap now and expensive later:

- Collect only an email or phone number plus home airport
- A plain-language notice at signup, with separate tick boxes for deal alerts and for marketing
- One-tap unsubscribe and a "delete my data" button
- A written breach-response plan and a named grievance contact
- Cookie-light, privacy-friendly analytics

Sources for this section: OneSignal: web push for iOS · Thinktecture: Bubblewrap to Google Play · MobiLoud: publishing a PWA to the app stores · web.dev: Core Web Vitals thresholds · Outlook Business: DPDP Rules notified · KPMG: DPDP Rules 2025 guidance

Protecting our data from scrapers

The honest starting point. No public website can be made impossible to scrape. If a phone can show a deal, a determined bot can read it too, and anyone promising "unscrapable" is overselling. What we *can* do is make copying us slow, expensive, easy to spot, legally risky and not worth it, because whatever they copy is already stale. One more point to keep us consistent: our own engine reads Google Flights through Scrape.do. So our stance is "our curated deals, write-ups and database are ours", not "all scraping is illegal".

Seven layers of protection.

1. **Cloudflare in front of everything.**
   - The free plan gives Bot Fight Mode, firewall rules, basic per-IP rate limits and Turnstile, an invisible check that replaces captchas.
   - The Pro plan adds Super Bot Fight Mode, which uses JavaScript detection and lets verified bots like Googlebot through. That matters, because we must not block Google.
   - We also block AI crawlers.
   - Machine-learning bot scores are Enterprise-only and not needed early on.
2. **Show less to strangers.**
   - Anyone can see a deal's route, price and headline dates. That is good for Google and for sharing.
   - The full working-date grid, the price history and the all-routes list need a free account.
   - There is no public bulk feed: our current `/api/deals` goes behind a login token, and results are paged with hard caps.
3. **Lock the app's back door.**

- The app proves to our server that it is our genuine app on a real phone, using Google Play Integrity on Android and Apple App Attest on iPhone. Scripts and modified apps fail this check.
- Our server then issues short-lived tokens (about 15 minutes).
- Limits: Play Integrity's free tier allows about 10,000 checks a day, and rooted phones can sometimes fake it. So this sits on top of rate limits and never replaces them.

4. **Rate limits per person, not just per IP.**
   - Each account and device gets a daily quota of deal views and searches.
   - Bursts, such as 200 pages in a minute or every route in order, get a challenge first and a block after that.
5. **Traps that prove copying.**
   - Hidden honeypot links that only bots follow. They are excluded in robots.txt so Google never touches them, and any visitor that follows one is flagged.
   - Occasional "canary" details unique to each account, such as tiny differences in wording or rounding. If our deals appear on another site, we can tell which account leaked them.
6. **Speed is our moat.**
   - Alert subscribers get each deal first. The public page goes live 30–60 minutes later.
   - Deals expire within hours or days, and our `/go/` booking link is a signed, short-lived redirect that never exposes the raw booking URL.
   - A copier is always late, and the deals they copied die quickly.
7. **Legal backstop.**
   - Terms of Use that ban automated access and republishing.
   - Copyright in our write-ups, images and compiled database.
   - A registered trademark for the brand.
   - Takedown notices to hosts, Instagram and Telegram when someone reposts our deals.
   - This deters the casual copier. It will not stop an anonymous offshore bot, which is what layers 1–6 are for.

Who tries to copy us	What stops them
A curious person with a script	Cloudflare, rate limits
A competitor's scraper on cloud servers	Bot Fight Mode, login wall, quotas, honeypots
A paid residential-proxy scraping service	Per-account quotas, canary data, the 30–60 minute head start

Who tries to copy us	What stops them
A modified copy of our app	Play Integrity / App Attest, short-lived tokens
An Instagram page reposting our deals	Watermarked share images, trademark, takedowns

What we will not do. We will not hide content behind heavy scrambling or images of text. That hurts Google ranking, screen readers and page speed, and determined bots get past it anyway.

Sources for this section: Cloudflare: stop malicious bots (Free, Pro, Business) · Cloudflare: protect forms with Turnstile · NativePHP: securing public mobile APIs with Play Integrity and App Attest · Ionic: Play Integrity

Next 10 actions

The first three unblock everything else and take under a day.

#	Action	Owner	Done when
1	Rotate the Scrape.do key and put the new one in `.env`	Engine	Old key revoked
2	Run `setup.bat`, then `test-real.bat` (50 real searches, ~500 credits)	Engine	50 real prices stored, 0 errors
3	Start `start.bat` and leave it scanning for 14 days	Engine	Deals per day measured
4	Pick the brand name and buy the domain	Growth	Domain owned
5	Register the company (needed for affiliate payouts)	Growth	Registration number
6	Apply to Skyscanner, Travelpayouts, Agoda, Booking.com and Stay22	Growth	5 applications sent
7	Open Telegram channels for Delhi and Mumbai and post real deals daily	Growth	2 channels live
8	Finish the app (install, push, saved deals) and apply the new design to the live site	Engine	Installable on Android and iPhone
9	Test hotel data: 1 city, 10 check-in dates, compare against Agoda and Booking.com prices	Engine	Price match within 5% on most hotels

#	Action	Owner	Done when
10	Get a short legal review of data sources and site terms	Growth	Written advice in hand

Sources

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- Best hotel affiliate programmes in 2026, Stay22
- Google Hotels API fields, SerpApi
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- Google Hotels scraper, ScrapingBee
- Google Hotels scraper, Bright Data